

12 lakh jobs till 2025.Specifically, between 2005 and 2020, the government facilitated 8 lakh government jobs. Post-2020, this momentum accelerated with 5.16 lakh jobs already provided, 1.99 lakh appointments in the final stages, and plans for 5.17 lakh more appointments underway. This achievement demonstrates the government's commitment to job creation and the seamless execution of employment-oriented policies.

A significant portion of these jobs has been in the education sector. In a historic move, the government recruited 1,20,336 teachers in a single advertisement, including 70,545 primary teachers, 26,089 secondary teachers, and 23,702 higher secondary teachers. This initiative not only addressed the employment crisis but also aimed to enhance the quality of education in the state. Pertinently, the recruitment included 14,000 teachers from other states, underscoring Bihar's commitment to meritocracy and inclusive growth.

In an innovative approach to promote sports and recognise athletic talent, the government introduced the "Medal Lao Naukri Pao" scheme. Under the "The Bihar Outstanding Sportspersons Direct Appointment Rules-2023," athletes who win medals in national and international competitions are directly recruited into government jobs, with positions ranging from Sub-Divisional Officer (SDO) to Deputy Superintendent of Police (Dy. SP). So far, 342 athletes have benefitted from this scheme, highlighting the government's dedication to encouraging sports among the youth.

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WOMEN'S EMPOWERMENT: BREAKING BARRIERS

Nitish Kumar's administration has made significant strides in women's empowerment, including reservations for women in local bodies and jobs.In 2006, the government introduced 50 per cent reservation for women in Panchayati Raj Institutions. It was further extended to urban local bodies as well in 2007, setting a precedent for increased female participation in decision-making at grass-roots level. This move empowered women to step out of traditional roles and take up leadership positions in governance. Also, in education sector recruitment, 48 per cent of the selected teachers were women, further promoting gender equality.

The government's commitment to women's empowerment extends to law enforcement. In 2013, a 35 per cent reservation for women was implemented in police recruitment, significantly increasing the number of female officers. Today, Bihar boasts over 29,000 women in its police force, the highest in India, with women constituting 29 per cent of the force compared to the national average of 16.05 per cent. This substantial increase has made Bihar a model for gender inclusivity in law enforcement.

Recognising the importance of education, the government launched the **"Mukhyamantri Balika Cycle Yojana"** in 2006, providing financial assistance to girls for purchasing bicycles to commute to school. This initiative, along with the **"Mukhyamantri Poshak Youjana"** significantly encouraged girls' education, increasing female school enrolment and attendance. Furthering this effort, the **"Mukhyamantri Kanya Utthan Yojana"** was introduced, offering financial incentives for girls to complete their graduation. These initiatives have collectively contributed to an appreciable decline in Bihar's fertility rate from 4.3 to 2.9,



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